

COMMITTEES/COMMISSIONS IN INDIA BEFORE INDEPENDENCE

During their rule in India, the British established numerous committees and commissions across various fields, including education and law enforcement. These commissions were created to implement reforms and modernise operational structures within the British Empire. Let us have a look at the British Indian committees and commissions established for judicial, administrative, and social reforms.

Committee/Commission/Year/Chairman	Objectives	Governor General/Viceroy
Agriculture & Irrigation		
Madras Agricultural Committee- 1890	To examine the necessity of abandoning attempts to teach the ryot until more is known about his practices and conditions.	Lord Lansdowne
Scott-Moncrieff Commission- 1901 Chairman: Sir Colin Scott Moncrieff	To plan for the expenditure on irrigation.	Lord Curzon
Maclagan Committee- 1914-15 Chairman: Maclagan	To advise on cooperative finances.	Lord Hardinge II
Linlithgow Commission- 1928 Chairman: Linlithgow	To study the problems of agriculture.	Lord Irwin
Education		
Hunter Commission- 1882 Chairman: William Hunter	To study the development in education.	Lord Rippon
University Commission- 1902 Chairman: Thomas Raleigh	To study the universities and introduce reforms.	Lord Curzon
Calcutta University Commission- 1917 Chairman: Michael Sadler	To study the conditions of the university.	Lord Chelmsford
Hartog Committee- 1929 Chairman: Philip Hartog	It focused on reviewing the state of education in India. It was a part of broader efforts to examine the results of educational reforms initiated after the Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms of 1919.	Irwin
Sargent Plan- 1944 Chairman: John Sargent	To raise the standards of education to match those in Britain.	Lord Wavell
Governance		
Hunter Committee Report (Disorders Inquiry Committee)- 1919 Chairman: William Hunter	To investigate the Punjab disturbances.	Lord Chelmsford
Muddiman Committee- 1924 Chairman: Sir Alexander Muddiman	To examine the working of diarchy under the Montague-Chelmsford reforms.	Lord Reading
Butler Commission- 1927 Chairman: Sir Harcourt Butler	To examine the relationship between Indian states and the British Crown.	Lord Irwin
Simon Commission- 1928 Chairman: Sir John Simon	To investigate the progress of the governance scheme and suggest new reforms.	Lord Irwin

Economic Commissions/Committees		
Whitley Commission- 1929 Chairman: JH Whitley	To study the condition of labour in Industries and gardens.	Lord Irwin
Indian Measurement Committee- 1935 Chairman: L.F. Harmand	To arrange for the inclusion of labour in the Federal Assembly.	Lord Willingdon
Sapru Commission(Unemployment)- 1935 Chairman: Tej Bahdur Sapru	To address unemployment issues in the United Provinces.	Lord Linlithgow
National Planning Committee- 1938 Chairman: Jawaharlal Nehru	To prepare an economic plan.	Congress committee
Chatfield Commission (Army)- 1939 Lord Chatfield	To assess the army's needs and reforms.	Lord Linlithgow
Floud Commission (Tenancy Issues)- 1940 Chairman: Francis Floud	To investigate tenancy issues in Bengal.	Lord Linlithgow
Famine		
Famine Inspection Commission 1943-44 Chairman: John Woodhood	To investigate the events of the Bengal famine.	Lord Wavell
Campbell Commission- 1866 Chairman: Sir George Campbell	To investigate the causes of famine in Odisha and suggest ways to prevent its recurrence. It blamed the government machinery for the tragedy and suggested relief measures.	Lord Lawrence
Strachey Commission- 1880 Chairman: Richard Strachey	To provide recommendations, including the formulation of a Famine Code, development of irrigation facilities, suspension of land revenue collection during famines, collection of data about Indian agriculture and peasantry, and establishment of a Famine fund.	Lord Lytton
Lyll Commission- 1897 Chairman: James Lyall	To recommend the development of irrigation facilities.	Lord Elgin
MacDonnell Commission- 1900 Chairman: Anthony MacDonnell	To recommend changes based on findings from recent famines, emphasising that the official machinery dealing with a famine must operate year-round to control food grain scarcity effectively.	Lord Curzon
Law		
First Law Commission- 1834 Chairman: Lord Macaulay	To recommend the codification of the Penal Code, the Criminal Procedure Code, and other matters.	Lord William Bentinck
Second Law Commission- 1853 Chairman: Sir John Romilly	To recommend the Indian Code of Civil Procedure, the Indian Contract Act, etc.	Lord Dalhousie
Third Law Commission- 1861 Chairman: Sir John Romilly	To recommend the Indian Evidence Act, the Transfer of Property Act, etc.	Lord Canning
Fourth Law Commission- 1879 Chairman: Dr. Whitley Stokes	To recommend codes on Negotiable Instruments, Trusts Law, Transfer of Property, Easements, Criminal Procedure, and Civil Procedure.	Lord Lytton

Currency		
Herschell Committee- 1893 Chairman: Herschell	To provide suggestions regarding currency.	Lord Lansdowne
Henry Fowler Commission- 1898 Chairman: H. Fowler	To provide suggestions on currency.	Lord Elgin
Babington Smith Commission- 1919 Chairman: Babington Smith	To investigate the state of Indian currency and suggest reforms.	Lord Chelmsford
Hilton Young Commission-1926 Chairman: Edward Hilton Young	To review currency policies.	Lord Linlithgow
Civil Service		
Aitchison Commission- 1886 Chairman: Charles Aitchison	To involve more Indians in the Civil Service.	Lord Dufferin
Fraser Commission- 1902 Chairman: Fraser	To investigate the working of police.	Lord Curzon
Royal Commission on Civil Service - 1912 Chairman: Lord Islington	To recommend giving 25% of high posts to Indians.	Lord Hardinge
Lee Commission- 1924 Chairman: Lord Lee	To remove defects in the Civil Service.	Lord Reading
Other Committees/Commissions		
Shore Committee- 1914	To fight for the rights of the passengers of the Komagata Maru Incident of 1914.	Hussain Rahim, Sohan Lal Pathak, and Balwant Singh
Lottery Committee- 1817	Assisted the government in the task of town planning in Calcutta.	Lord Hastings
Opium Commission- 1893	To investigate the effects of opium on health.	Lord Lansdowne
Rowlatt Committee- 1917 Chairman: Sydney Rowlatt	A Sedition Committee which authorised the arrest, for 2 years without trial, of any person suspected of terrorism living in British India.	Lord Chelmsford
Southborough Committee OR Indian Franchise Committee- 1918-19 Chairman: Francis Hopwood	To decide on the issue of franchise.	Lord Chelmsford
Feetham Function Committee- 1918-19 Chairman: Richard Feetham	It proposed a suggested allocation of subjects between the Center and the Provinces, addressing the division of provincial subjects into Reserved and Transferred categories as well.	Lord Chelmsford
Indian Jail Reforms Committee-1919 Chairman: Sir Alexander Cardew	To improve the conditions of prisoners.	Lord Chelmsford
Sandhurst Committee- 1926 Chairman: Andrew Skeen	To suggest Indianization of the Indian Army.	Lord Reading
Indian Franchise Committee OR Lothian Committee- 1932 Chairman: Lothian	The Communal Award of 1932, rooted in the conclusions of the Lothian Committee, instituted distinct electorates and allocated reserved seats for minorities. Notably, the depressed classes were accorded seventy-eight reserved seats.	Lord Willingdon

EVOLUTION OF EDUCATION IN COLONIAL INDIA

Overview of British Educational Policy

- The British educational policy in India was **dualistic**, focusing on promoting **western education** and the **English language** while limiting indigenous, oriental educational systems.
- This approach became known as the **Downward Filtration Theory** and influenced subsequent policies and commissions, notably the **Hunter Commission**.

Company Rule and Initial Educational Initiatives

The East India Company, primarily focused on trade, showed **minimal interest in education** (Until 1813).

A few limited initiatives by individuals are as follows:

[UPSC 2018]

- Calcutta Madrasah (1781):** Warren Hastings established it for the study of Muslim law and related subjects.
- Sanskrit College (1791):** Jonathan Duncan set it up at Benaras for the study of Hindu law and philosophy.
- Fort William College (1800):** Wellesley established it to train civil servants of the Company in the languages and customs of Indians (closed in 1802). [UPSC 2020]

Name of College	Founder	Year of Establishment	Details
Calcutta Madrasah	Warren Hastings	1781	First institution for the study of Muslim culture and traditions in India.
Sanskrit College (Varanasi)	Jonathan Duncan	1791	Focused on Sanskrit studies and ancient Indian learning.
Hindu College (Calcutta)	David Hare	1817	One of the first institutions to introduce Western education in India.
Vedanta College (Calcutta)	Raja Ram Mohan Roy	1825	Aimed at synthesising Western learning with Vedantic ideals.
Bethune School (Calcutta)	Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar (Established by J.E. Bethune)	1849	First school for girls in Calcutta, promoted by Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar.
Three Universities (Calcutta, Madras, Bombay)	Lord Canning (Governor General)	1857	Established as part of the British policy to educate Indians.
Thomson College of Civil Engineering (IIT Roorkee)	James Thomson	1847	Renowned institution for engineering education, now part of IIT Roorkee.
Central Hindu School - (Banaras)	Annie Besant (Established, converted to Banaras Hindu University by Madan Mohan Malviya)	Date not specified	Initially set up as a school, later became part of Banaras Hindu University.
Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental College (MAO) - Aligarh	Sayyid Ahmad Khan	1875	Later became Aligarh Muslim University, pivotal in Muslim education.
National Muslim University	Sayyid Ahmed Bareilvi (Later transferred to Delhi, became Jamia Millia Islamia)	Date not specified	Initially founded in Aligarh, later moved to Delhi.
New English School (Bombay)	Vishnushastri Chiplunkar, Bal Gangadhar Tilak, M.B. Namjoshi, G.G. Agarkar	1880s	Later became Fergusson College, a major institution in Pune.
National Council of Education (Calcutta)	Aurobindo Ghosh	1906	Established to promote national education, under the leadership of Aurobindo Ghosh.
SNDT Women's University	Maharishi Karve	1916	Focused on women's education, founded by Maharishi Karve.

CHARTER ACT OF 1813: A MODEST BEGINNING

- Incorporated the principle of promoting knowledge of **modern sciences**, allocating **one lakh rupees annually** for education, though implementation was delayed until **1823**. [UPSC - 2018]
- **Raja Rammohan Roy** influenced funding for **Calcutta College (1817)**, established by **educated Bengalis** to provide **English education** in **Western humanities** and **sciences**.
- The government established three **Sanskrit colleges** in **Calcutta, Delhi, and Agra**.

Orientalist - Anglicist Controversy

A 19th-century debate on education:

- **Orientalists** supported **traditional Indian learning**, while **Anglicists** favoured a **Western-focused education**. [UPSC 2018]
- Disagreement among Anglicists included the **medium of instruction**, divided between **English** and **vernacular languages**.

Lord Macaulay's Minute (1835)

- Lord Macaulay held the view that “**Indian learning was inferior to European learning**”.
- It settled in **favour of Anglicists**. **English** became the **medium** in schools and colleges, **neglecting mass education** and government resources dedicated to **Western sciences and literature**.
- It planned to **educate a small section of upper middle classes** who would act as interpreters and be “**Indian in blood and colour but English in tastes, in opinions, in morals and in intellect**”. This was known as the **Downward Filtration Theory**.

Thomson's Village Education (1843-53)

- James Thomson (lieutenant governor of North-West Provinces) introduced **vernacular-based village education**, teaching practical subjects to Revenue and Public Works Department personnel.

Charles Wood's Despatch (1854)-Governor-General: Lord Dalhousie

- **Objective:** To develop a structured educational policy in India.
- **The Magna Carta of English Education** [UPSC 2018]
- **Key Recommendations:**
 - **Western Education:** Emphasised **European sciences, arts, philosophy, and literature** as core to the curriculum, promoting **liberal education**.
 - **Primary Medium:** Recommended **English** as the primary medium for higher education, while also stressing the importance of **vernacular languages** for reaching the masses.

- **Institutional Structure:** Proposed primary schools in villages, Anglo-Vernacular high schools at the district level, and affiliated colleges.
- **Grants-in-Aid System:** Suggested a system to support private initiatives in education, contingent upon maintaining **quality standards** and hiring qualified teachers.

POST-WOOD'S DESPATCH DEVELOPMENTS (LATE 19TH CENTURY)

- **Establishment of Universities** (1857) in Calcutta, Bombay, and Madras universities.
- The **Bethune School**, founded by **J.E.D. Bethune** at Calcutta (1849). Bethune was the President of the Council of Education, and due to his effort, girls' schools were set up on a sound footing and brought under the government's grants-in-aid and inspection system.
- **Technical Institutes** like the Agriculture Institute at Pusa (Bihar) and the Engineering Institute at Roorkee were established.
- The dominance of ideals in Wood's Despatch (19th Century) led to the **Westernization of the education system** with European-run institutions.
- Also, missionary enterprises and private Indian efforts gradually emerged.

Hunter Commission (1882)-

Governor-General: Lord Ripon

- **Objective:** To review the implementation of Wood's Despatch and assess elementary education in British India.
- **Key Recommendations:**
 - **Dual Track in High School Education:** Advocated two types of secondary education, focusing on **vocational and commercial training** alongside **literary studies** for university admission.
 - **Primary Education Emphasis:** Emphasised **primary education** in local languages with practical subjects, promoting **private efforts** but under public provision.
 - **Decentralisation:** Recommended that **district and city boards** take charge of primary education.
 - In the coming years, there was rapid growth and expansion of secondary and collegiate education with the participation of Indians. Teaching-cum-examining universities were set up, such as **Punjab University (1882)** and **Allahabad University (1887)**.

Indian Universities Act, 1904

- The **Raleigh Commission (1902)** was set up to go into the conditions and prospects of universities in India and to suggest measures for improvement in their constitution and working.
- The commission precluded reporting on primary or secondary education.

Based on the committees recommendations the Indian Universities Act, 1904 was passed with the following provisions:

- Universities are instructed to **prioritise study and research**.
- Reduced the number of university fellows and increased government nomination.
- The government gained the power to veto and amend university regulations.
- Stricter condition for affiliation of private colleges.
- Sanctioned funds (5 lakh per annum) for the improvement of higher education and universities.
- **Curzon** justified these measures in the name of quality and efficiency, but actually sought to restrict education and to discipline the educated towards loyalty to the government. Nationalists saw it as an attempt to strengthen imperialism.
- **Gokhale** referred to it as a “retrograde measure.”

Government Resolution on Education Policy (1913)

The **Government Resolution on Education Policy (1913)** marked an important step influenced by **Baroda's Compulsory Primary Education (1906)** and **Gokhale's Resolution of 1910**. These developments, pushed by national leaders, aimed to introduce structured reforms in education.

Gokhale's Resolution of 1910

- **Compulsory Primary Education:** Proposed making primary education mandatory in areas where at least **35%** of **6-7-year-old boys** were already receiving instruction.
- **Cost Sharing:** Allowed **state governments and local authorities** to determine the financial contributions for education costs.
- **Central Education Department:** Recommended establishing a **separate department of education** under the **central government** to oversee compulsory education.
- **Education Secretary:** Suggested appointing a **Secretary for Education** to monitor progress and prepare budget reports.
- Gokhale withdrew the resolution based on **government assurances** to address educational reforms. [UPSC 2018]

Government Response and Policy Outcomes

- **Compulsory Education:** The government declined direct responsibility for compulsory education but committed to reducing **illiteracy**. Provinces were encouraged to provide **free elementary education** for the **poor and marginalised sections**.
- **Support for Private Efforts:** Promoted **private initiatives** in education and prioritised enhancing the **quality of secondary schools**.
- **Provincial Universities:** Recommended establishing a **university in each province** to expand higher education access.

Women's Education

- **Practical Curriculum:** Suggested a **practical utility-focused curriculum** for girls, minimising emphasis on **examinations**.
- **Increase in Women Teachers:** Advocated for hiring more **female teachers and inspectors** to support women's education and improve its quality.

Sadler University Commission (1917-1919)

Chairman: Michael Sadler

Objective: The commission was initially set up to study **Calcutta University** but its recommendations were applicable to other universities as well. It reviewed the entire field of education, from school to university. The key recommendations included:

- **12-Year Schooling System:** Advocated for a **12-year school course**, where students would enter university after an **intermediate stage** (instead of matriculation) for a **three-year degree course**.
 - This was intended to:
 - ◆ Better prepare students for university.
 - ◆ Relieve universities from a large number of below-university standard students.
 - ◆ Provide **collegiate education** for those not intending to go to university.
- **Separate Board for Secondary Education:** Proposed the creation of a **separate board for secondary and intermediate education** to control and administer these stages of education.
- **University Autonomy:** Suggested a centralization of universities as **autonomous bodies**, advocating for less rigidity in university regulations.
- **Female and Technical Education:** Recommended extending **female education**, promoting **applied scientific and technological education**, and improving **teachers' training**, including for **vocational colleges**.

Impact:

- From **1916 to 1921**, **seven new universities** were established, including those in **Mysore, Patna, Benaras, Aligarh, Dacca, Lucknow, and Osmania**.
- Universities increased in number, with more **teaching and residential universities**.
- **Honours courses** were introduced, leading to increased academic activities in universities and colleges.
- New **academic councils** were created for university governance, improving **internal administration**, including curriculum construction, examination, and research.
- The **Inter-University Board** was established in **1925** to facilitate coordination among universities.
- For the first time, **student welfare** became an important concern in universities, with **students' welfare boards** established in each university. [UPSC 2017]

University Name	Established In
Banaras Hindu University	1916
Mysore University	1916
Patna University	1917
Osmania University, Hyderabad	1918
Aligarh University	1920
Lucknow University	1921
Dacca University	1921
Delhi University	1922
Andhra University	1926
Agra University	1927
Annamalai University	1929

Education Under Dyarchy (1919)

Following the **Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms**, **responsibility for education was transferred to provincial ministries**. This period marked a significant shift towards decentralisation in the administration of education. [UPSC 2019]

Hartog Committee (1929)

Chair: Phillip Hartog, Appointed by the **Simon Commission**, the committee was set up to assess the deteriorating educational standards in India. Its key recommendations were:

Primary Education

- **Government Control:** Advocated for **government control and inspection** of **primary schools** to address issues of **stagnation** and **wastage**.
- **Local Relevance:** Suggested that the curriculum should be suited to the local environment and needs, with subjects having **practical value** for students.
- **Teacher Improvement:** Recommended **refresher courses** and **training programs** for primary school teachers.
- **Community Centres:** Proposed that primary schools should also function as **community centres**, offering **adult education**, **medical relief**, and **recreational facilities** for rural areas.

Secondary Education

- **Diversified Curriculum:** Criticised the **exam-focused** secondary education system and advocated for a **more diversified curriculum**, including **industrial** and **commercial subjects**.

Higher Education

- **Affiliated Universities:** Recommended the establishment of **affiliated universities** alongside unitary models and improvements in university **libraries** and the introduction of **honours courses**.
- **Admission by Aptitude:** Advocated for **admissions based on abilities and aptitudes** rather than rote memorization.

Women's Education

- **Equal Importance:** Proposed giving **equal importance** to **boys' and girls' education**.
- **Female Teachers:** Suggested the establishment of more primary schools for girls and emphasised training **women for teaching jobs**.
- **Curriculum Changes:** Recommended that the **secondary school curriculum for girls** should include subjects like **hygiene**, **home science**, and **music**.

Impact: The committee's recommendations contributed to the **improvement of primary and secondary education** in India, and led to the creation of more **affiliated colleges**. [UPSC 2016]

Sargent Plan of Education (1944)

Objective: Drafted by **Sir John Sargent**, the Government of India's Educational Advisor, the plan aimed to improve **Indian education** post-World War II. Key recommendations included:

- **Free Pre-primary Education:** Advocated for **free pre-primary education** for **children aged 3-6 years**, with **trained female teachers**.
- **Compulsory Education (6-11 years):** Recommended **universal, compulsory, and free education** for children aged **6-11 years**, focusing on **learning through education** and **physical training**.
- **Six-Year High School Education:** Proposed **six years of high school education** for children aged **11-17 years**, with both **academic** and **vocational streams**. **Mother tongue** would be the medium of instruction, and **English** would be the compulsory second language.
- **University Education:** After completing the higher secondary exam, a **three-year university degree** was proposed, with improvements in **university standards** and a change in **admission procedures** to allow capable students to enter.
- **Financial Assistance for Poor Students:** Suggested that **financial assistance** be provided to poor students to ensure equal access to education.
- **Improvement of Teachers:** Stressed that **teachers** should be **competent**, with improved **service conditions**.
- **Research and Post-Graduate Education:** Focused on **high standards** in **post-graduate studies** and **applied research**.
- **All-India Coordination:** Proposed the creation of an **all-India body** like the **University Grants Committee** in England to coordinate university activities.
- **Additional Provisions:** Called for the **liquidation of adult illiteracy**, the promotion of **adult education**, **medical check-ups in schools**, and **special education** for the **physically handicapped**.

Impact: This plan laid the foundation for the development of **compulsory and free education** and **teacher training** programs in India. [UPSC 2020]

Wardha Scheme of Basic Education (1937)

Initiated by: Congress under the **Zakir Hussain Committee**

Principle: The **Nai Talim** or ‘**learning through activity**’ scheme was rooted in **Gandhian philosophy** and aimed at promoting **practical skills** through education.

Key Features:

- **Free and Compulsory Education:** Advocated for free and compulsory education for children for first 7 years of school.
- **Mother Tongue and Hindi:** Education was to be conducted in the **mother tongue**, with **Hindi** taught in areas where it was not the local language.
- **Community Engagement:** Encouraged **community participation** through **service activities** around schools.
- **Curriculum:** Included **mathematics, general science, social studies, painting, music, and physical education**, while excluding **religious education**.

Impact: This scheme aimed to integrate **practical skills** with education, but due to **World War II** and the **resignation of Congress ministries** in 1939, its development was **limited**. [UPSC 2015]

Note: Following factors were responsible for introduction of English Education in India under Charter Act of 1813, General Committee of Public Instruction, 1823 & Orientalist and Anglicist Controversy [UPSC 2018]

DEVELOPMENT OF INDIAN PRESS

The **Indian press** has significantly influenced public opinion, government policies, and awareness of both domestic and international events. Its role has evolved over time to meet the needs of society and the government.

Background

- **Portuguese** introduced printing in **India** in **1557** with the **Jesuits of Goa** publishing the first book.
- **1684:** The **East India Company** established a press in **Bombay**. However, no newspapers were published in the Company’s territories for nearly a century, mainly to suppress news of misconduct.

Pioneers in Indian Journalism

- **1776:** **William Bolts**, after being censured by the Company, tried to publish a newspaper to expose its wrongdoings, but was stopped by the authorities.
- **1780:** **James Augustus Hickey** launched **The Bengal Gazette**, the first Indian newspaper. It was known for its **outspoken criticism** of the government. Hickey’s press was seized in **1782** due to his attacks on officials.

Early Nationalists’ Efforts for Press Freedom

- **1824:** **Raja Rammohan Roy** protested against press restrictions, beginning the call for press freedom.

- **1870–1918:** The press played a key role in the **nationalist movement**, using newspapers like **The Hindu**, **Bengalee**, and **Amrita Bazar Patrika** for **political propaganda** and **education**.
- Journalists like **G. Subramania Aiyar**, **Dadabhai Naoroji**, and **Bal Gangadhar Tilak** shaped the press’ role in political engagement and education.
- **Section 124A of the Indian Penal Code:** Penalised sedition, punishing those attempting to incite disaffection against the British government. Nationalist journalists developed strategies like starting critical writings with loyalty statements or quoting foreign sources to bypass restrictions.
- Despite laws like **Section 124A** (sedition), nationalist journalists overcame legal hurdles, and the **Vernacular Press Act of 1878** targeted nationalist publications, demonstrating ongoing struggles for **press freedom**.

Evolution of Indian Press, Related Acts, and Regulations

- **Censorship of Press Act, 1799:** By Lord Wellesley, anticipating a French invasion. Imposed strict press restrictions, including pre-censorship. Publishers had to submit material for government approval. Violation led to immediate deportation.
 - **Expansion (1807):** Applied to journals, pamphlets, and books.
 - Under Lord Hastings, pre-censorship was abolished in 1818, though guidelines were set for editors to prevent the publication of content undermining government authority.
- **Licensing Regulations, 1823:** By Acting Governor-General John Adams. Required a licence for operating a printing press. A fine of Rs. 400 or imprisonment for unlicensed printing; magistrates could seize unlicensed presses. Primarily aimed at Indian-language newspapers and those edited by Indians. Raja Ram Mohan Roy’s “Mirat-ul-Akbar” was forced to stop publication, and only a few newspapers continued in Calcutta.
- **Press Act of 1835 (Metcalf Act):** Charles Metcalfe repealed the 1823 regulations, becoming known as the “**Liberator of the Indian Press**.” Required printers and publishers to provide accurate details about their premises. Allowed cessation of operations by declaration. This led to a rapid expansion of newspapers across India. The more liberal approach lasted until 1856.
- **Licensing Act, 1857:** Introduced after the 1857 revolt as an emergency measure. Reinforced licensing requirements; government had the power to revoke licences and halt the publication or circulation of materials. It was a temporary measure, lasting one year, but Charles Metcalfe’s previous regulations remained in place.
- **Registration Act, 1867:** Replaced the Metcalfe Act of 1835 and focused on regulation instead of restriction. Required every book or newspaper to display the printer’s name, publisher, and place of publication. A copy had to

be submitted to the local government within a month. Continued amendments in 1890, 1914, 1952, and 1963. Introduced in parallel with **Section 124-A** of the Indian Penal Code, which addressed sedition.

- **The Vernacular Press Act, 1878:** The vernacular press, especially after the 1857 revolt, became increasingly vocal in criticising the British government. Public discontent grew due to the 1876-77 famine and extravagant government spending during Lord Lytton's administration. The Vernacular Press Act was introduced to curb "seditious writing" in vernacular languages.

Provisions of the Vernacular Press Act, 1878

- Empowered **District Magistrates** to compel printers and publishers to enter bonds, preventing publications from inciting disaffection or fostering antipathy.
- **No Right of Appeal:** Decisions made by Magistrates were final and unappealable in court.
- **Censorship:** The press could submit content to a government censor for approval to avoid punishment.
- **Confiscation of Equipment:** Repeated violations could result in the seizure of printing presses and equipment.
- **Security Deposit:** Publishers could be forced to deposit security that would be forfeited if regulations were violated.
- **Discrimination:** The Act treated the vernacular press more harshly than the English press, earning the derogatory term "Gagging Act."
- **Repeal and Aftermath: Pre-censorship Clause Removed (1878)** following objections by Lord Cranbrook, the pre-censorship clause was removed. A **Press Commissioner** was appointed to provide accurate news to the press.
- Under **Lord Ripon**, the Vernacular Press Act was **repealed (1882)** after widespread protests, as the justification for it no longer held.

Development After 1882

- **Surendranath Banerjee (1883):** The first Indian journalist to be imprisoned for criticising a judge in **The Bengalee**. He was jailed for criticising the insensitivity of a Calcutta High Court judge towards Bengali religious sentiments.
- **Section 124A Amendment (1898):** The amendment expanded sedition laws, making it a criminal offence to bring contempt upon the Government of India or incite hatred between classes.

Repression Against National Journalists During the Extremist Phase

- **Bal Gangadhar Tilak's Role:** Through his newspapers *Kesari* and *Maharatta*, and initiatives like the **Ganapati** and **Shivaji festivals**, Tilak promoted **anti-imperialist sentiments**. Led the **boycott of foreign cloth** (1896) and **no-tax movement** (1897) in Maharashtra, protesting British policies.

- **Plague Unrest (1897):** Supported government anti-plague measures, but the harsh methods sparked public discontent and led to the **Chapekar brothers' assassinating British official Rand**.
- **Sedition Charges Against Tilak:** Arrested for publishing a **poem** and delivering a **speech** justifying **Shivaji's actions**, resulting in an **18-month** prison sentence. His imprisonment sparked nationwide protests, elevating him as **Lokmanya** ("Respected by the People").

Repressive Laws During the Swadeshi Movement

- **Newspaper (Incitement to Offences) Act, 1908:** Aimed to suppress **Extremist nationalist press** and authorised **magistrates** to seize **press property** for publishing inflammatory material. Tilak was arrested under this act, leading to **nationwide protests**.
- **Indian Press Act, 1910:** Empowered **local governments** to demand **security** from publishers and confiscate presses for objectionable content.

Defence of India Rules (First World War)

- Used to suppress **political dissent** under **wartime security**, **censorship** was intensified, especially against **Congress-related activities**.
- **Press Committee of 1921:** **Tej Bahadur Sapru** chaired the committee, recommending the **repeal** of the **Press Acts of 1908 and 1910**, signalling a shift in press regulation.

Press Act During the Civil Disobedience Movement

- **Press Ordinance of 1930:** This ordinance aimed to "provide for the better control of the Press" and revived the provisions of the **Press Act of 1910**.
- **Indian Press (Emergency Powers) Act, 1931:** In 1931, the **Indian Press (Emergency Powers) Act** was introduced, giving provincial governments broad powers to suppress media related to the Civil Disobedience Movement.
 - **Section 4 (1):** Penalised activities that incited violence or supported individuals involved in violent crimes.
 - **Criminal Amendment Act of 1932:** Expanded the powers of the Act, criminalising a wider array of activities undermining government authority.

During the Second World War

The **Defence of India Rules**, enacted during World War II, led to stricter censorship and increased government control over the press.

- **Pre-Censorship:** All content had to be approved by government authorities before publication, restricting any critical or nationalist viewpoints.
- **Press Emergency Act:** Reinforced by the re-enactment of the **Press Act of 1910**, this act allowed authorities to demand financial security from publishers and close down non-compliant newspapers.
- **Official Secrets Amendment:** Prohibited the publication of sensitive government information, with penalties for any disclosure.

Press Enquiry Committee (1947)

In 1947, the **Press Enquiry Committee** was formed to reassess press laws in light of India's transition to independence and the principles enshrined in the Indian Constitution.

Key Recommendations

- **Repeal of the Indian Emergency Powers Act, 1931:** Abolishing laws used to suppress political movements and dissent.
- **Amendments to the Press and Registration of Books Act:** To align with democratic principles and promote press freedom.
- **Changes to IPC Sections 124-A and 153-A:** To protect free expression and prevent misuse against dissent.

- **Repeal of the Indian States Protection Acts:** Aimed at promoting democratic freedoms in princely states.

Other Legislative Developments: Over time, additional acts further shaped the regulatory environment of the Indian press, including:

- The Press (Objectionable Matters) Act, 1951
- Press Commission, 1952
- The Delivery of Books and Newspapers (Public Libraries) Act, 1954
- The Working Journalists (Conditions of Service) and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1955
- The Newspaper (Price and Page) Act, 1956
- The Parliamentary Proceedings (Protection of Publications) Act, 1960

Newspapers and Journals

Newspaper/Founder	Description
Bengal Gazette, also known as Original Calcutta General Advertiser (1780) James Augustus Hickey	Place of Publication - Calcutta. Spread - Bengal, Bihar and Orissa. The first newspaper published in India in English. It was known for its provocative journalism and outspoken criticism of the British East India Company.
Madras Courier (1784/85) Richard Johnston	Place of Publication - Madras. It was the first newspaper to be published from Madras.
India Gazette (1787) Henry Louis Vivian Derozio	Place of Publication - Calcutta
Bombay Herald (1789)	Place of Publication-Bombay. It was the first newspaper to be published from Bombay. In English, it came with the title Indian Herald.
Bengal Gazette (1818) Harish Chandra Ray	Place of Publication- Calcutta. It was the first Bengali newspaper.
Sambad Kaumudi (1821) Raja Ram Mohan Roy	Place of Publication - Calcutta. Spread - Bengal and Bihar. A Bengali weekly newspaper that promoted social and religious reform. It played a significant role in the development of Bengali journalism and the Indian freedom struggle.
Mirat-ul-Akbar (1822) Raja Ram Mohan Roy	Place of Publication - Calcutta. Spread - Bengal and Bihar. It was the first Persian language journal that discussed current events and social issues.
Jam-i-Jahan Numah (1822)	Place of Publication - Calcutta. It was the first Urdu language paper. It was run by an English Firm.
Banga-Duta (1822) Raja Ram Mohan Roy and Dwarkanath Tagore	Place of Publication - Calcutta. It was a weekly, published in 4 different languages i.e., English, Bengali, Persian and Hindi.
Bombay Samachar (1822) Fardunjee Marzban	Place of Publication - Bombay. It was the first newspaper in Gujarati.

Bangadarshan(1873) Bankim Chandra Chatterji	Place of Publication - Calcutta In Bengali Language
Bombay Times (1838) Thomas Bennett.	Place of Publication - Bombay. It later, from 1861, came to be known as Times of India and is published till date. Founded by Robert Knight but actual publication started by Thomas Bennett.
Hindu Patriot (1853) Girishchandra Ghosh	Place of Publication - Calcutta Later, Harishchandra Mukherji became owner-cum-editor.
Rast Goftar (1851) Dadabhai Naoroji	Place of Publication - Bombay. Spread - Bombay, Gujarat, and Sindh. A Gujarati fortnightly newspaper that advocated for Indian economic and political rights. Naoroji used the newspaper to educate Indians about their rights and to mobilise them against British rule.
Voice of India (1883) Dadabhai Naoroji	Place of Publication - Bombay It was later incorporated into the Indian Spectator
East Indian (19th Century) Henry Louis Vivian Derozio	It was a daily newspaper.
Som Prakash (1858) Dwarkanath VidyaBhushan	Place of Publication - Calcutta. Spread - Bengal and Bihar. A Bengali weekly newspaper that promoted social, political and educational reforms. It was used to advocate for women's rights, education, and widow remarriage.
Indian Mirror (1862) Devendra Nath Tagore and Man Mohan Ghosh	Place of Publication - Calcutta. Spread - Bengal and Bihar It was an English, fortnightly newspaper that advocated for Indian self-rule, while criticising the British colonial rule and its policies.
The Bengalee (1862) Started by Girish Chandra Ghosh and later taken over by Surendranath Banerjee	Place of Publication - Calcutta. Spread - Bengal and Bihar. It was known for its critical stance against the British colonial government. It published articles on the economic exploitation of India, the political repression of Indians, and the social evils of British rule.
The Pioneer (1865) George Allen	Place of Publication - Allahabad Spread - United Provinces
National Paper (1865) Devendranath Tagore	Place of Publication - Calcutta
Amrita Bazar Patrika (1868) Sisir Kumar ghosh and Motilal Ghosh	Place of Publication - Calcutta. Spread - Bengal and Bihar It was Bengali in the beginning, however later it became English. It became a leading voice for bengali middle class
Tahzib-ul-Akhlaq (1871) Sir Syed Ahmed Khan	Place of Publication - Aligarh. Spread - North India. An Urdu language journal that advocated for women's education, reform in Muslim family law, and the modernization of Muslim society.
Indian Statesman (1875) Robert Knight	Place of Publication - Calcutta It was later renamed as The Statesman
The Hindu (1878) G.S. Iyer, Vir Raghavacharya and Subba Rao Pandit	Place of Publication - Madras. Spread - Madras and Mysore. It was initially a weekly newspaper; known for its moderate political view.
Swadeshamitran (1882) G. Subramaniya Iyer	Place of Publication - Madras One of the earliest Tamil newspapers and the longest in print.
The Advocate (1878) G.P. Verma	Place of Publication - Lucknow Spread - United Provinces

Newspaper/Founder	Description
Kesari (1881) Bal Gangadhar Tilak	Place of Publication - Poona. Spread - Bombay and Central India. A Marathi daily newspaper that advocated for Indian self-rule. Mahratta (1881): An English weekly
The Tribune (1881) Dayal Singh Majeetia	Place of Publication - Lahore. Spread - Punjab and North India. It was a daily newspaper
Arya Gazette (1882) Pandit Dayanand Saraswati	Place of Publication - Lahore. Spread - Punjab and North India. It was published in both English and Hindi, and it promoted the ideals of the Arya Samaj, such as social reform, religious education, and Hindu unity.
Akhbar-i-Am (1886) Maulavi Zakauallah	Place of Publication - Lahore Spread - Punjab and North India
Gaujrat and the Gujratis (1882) Behramji Malabari	Place of Publication - Bombay Spread - Bombay and Gujarat
Paridasak (1886) Bipin Chandra Pal (publisher)	It was a weekly
Sudharak (1888) Gopal Krishna Agarkar	Place of Publication - Poona. Spread - Bombay and Central India. A Marathi language newspaper that promoted social reform.
Hitavada (1911) GK Gokhale	Place of Publication - Nagpur. Spread - central India It was published in both English and Marathi. It advocated for social reform and economic development
Indu Prakash(1888) Gopalhari Deshmukh	Place of Publication - Poona Spread - Bombay and Central India
The Leader (1907) Madan Mohan Malviya	Place of Publication - Allahabad Spread - United Provinces
Prabuddha Bharat (1896) P. Aiyasami, B. R. Rajam Iyer, G. G. Narasimhacharya, and B. V. Kamesvara Iyer at the behest of Swami Vivekananda	Place of Publication - Calcutta Spread - India and the world An English language monthly journal that promoted Hindu philosophy and culture.
Udbodhana (1899) Swami Vivekananda	Place of Publication - Calcutta Spread - India and the world
Indian Opinion (1903) M.K Gandhi	Place of Publication - Durban, South Africa. Spread - South Africa and India. A weekly newspaper that advocated for rights of Indian immigrants.
Young India (1919) M.K Gandhi	Place of Publication - Ahmedabad. Spread - Bombay Presidency. A weekly journal that promoted Gandhi's philosophy of non-violence and civil disobedience
Nav Jeevan (1929) M.K Gandhi	Place of Publication - Ahmedabad. Spread - Bombay. A Gujarati language weekly that promoted social reforms and Gandhi's philosophy.
Harijan (1932) M.K Gandhi	Place of Publication - Ahmedabad. Spread - Bombay. An English and Hindi weekly journal that advocated for the rights of Dalits.

Sandhya (1906) Brahmabandhab Upadhyay	Place of Publication-Bengal
Kal (1906) Shivram Mahadev Paranjape	Place of Publication- Maharashtra Spread - Bombay and Central India
The Mussalman (1906) Zafar Ali Khan	Place of Publication - Calcutta Spread - Bengal and Bihar
Yugantar (1906) Barindra Kumar Ghosh and Bhupendra Dutta	Place of Publication - Bengal. It was a political weekly that served as the propaganda organ for revolutionary organisation Anushilan Samiti. It expounded and justified revolutionary violence against British Raj as a political tool for independence.
The Karmayogi (1909) Aurobindo Ghosh	Place of Publication - Puducherry Spread - India and the world. It was published in English
Kudi Arasu (1910) E.V. Ramaswamy Naicker (Periyar)	In Tamil language
Comrade (1911) Maulana Mohammad Ali	Place of Publication - Calcutta. Spread - Bengal and Bihar. An English language weekly that advocated for Indian self-rule and Muslim rights.
Al-Balagh (1912) Abul Kalam Azad	Place of Publication - Calcutta Spread - Bengal and Bihar. An Urdu weekly that supported Indian self-rule and Muslim rights
The Azad (1912) Abul Kalam Azad	Place of Publication - Calcutta Spread - Bengal and Bihar. Published in Urdu
Al-Hilal (1912) Abul Kalam Azad	Place of Publication - Calcutta Spread - Bengal and Bihar. An Urdu weekly newspaper that promoted Islamic thoughts and culture
Pratap (1913) Ganesh Shankar Vidyarthi	Place of Publication - Kanpur Spread - United Provinces
Bombay Chronicle (1913) It was started by Firoze Shah Mehta and was edited by B. G. Horniman	Place of Publication - Bombay Spread - Bombay and Gujarat It was a daily newspaper
New India (1914) Annie Besant	Place of Publication - Madras Spread - Madras and Mysore
Independent (1919) Motilal Nehru	Place of Publication - Allahabad Spread - United Provinces
Hindustan Times (1920) Sunder Singh Lyallpuri. Later edited by K. M. Panikkar	Place of Publication - Delhi Spread - All India. An English language daily newspaper, it was used as part of the Akali Dal Movement
Mook Nayak (1920) B.R. Ambedkar	Place of Publication - Bombay Spread - Bombay. A Marathi language weekly that advocated for rights of Dalits
Bahishkrit Bharat (1927) B.R. Ambedkar	A Marathi fortnightly
The Swarajya (1921) C. Rajagopalachari	Place of Publication - Madras Spread - Madras and Mysore. Published in English

The Milap (1923) M K Chand	Place of Publication - Lahore
Kranti (1927) S.S. Mirajkar, K.N. Joglekar, S.V. Ghatge	Place of Publication - Maharashtra
Langal and Ganabani (1927) Gopu Chakravarti and Dharani Goswami	Place of Publication - Bengal
The Forward (1933) C.P. Ramaswamy Iyer	Place of Publication - Bombay Spread in Bombay and Gujarat
Free Hindustan (1936) Tarak Nath Das	Place of Publication - Canada and USA. Spread in India and the world. An English language journal that advocated for self-rule and international cooperation.
Hindustan Dainik (1936) Madan Mohan Malaviya	Place of Publication - Lucknow. Spread in the United Provinces. A hindi language daily newspaper that advocated for Hindu nationalism.
Bandi Jivan Sachindranath Sanyal	Place of Publication - Bengal
National Herald (1938) Jawaharlal Nehru	Established in Lucknow. It was founded as a tool to win independence. It was banned by the British government in 1942 during the Quit India movement till 1945.
Indian Sociologist Shyamji Krishnavarma	Place of Publication - London
Bande Mataram Madam Bikaji Cama	Place of Publication - Paris
Talvar Virendranath Chattopadhyaya	Place of Publication - Berlin
Ghadar Lala Hardayal	Place of Publication - San Francisco. The Ghadar Party put out this weekly, meaning revolt, using a small hand press. It first came out in Urdu, then Gurumukhi. Later it was also published in Gujarati, Hindi, English, German etc.

